

Theodor Vararu

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I'm Theo, a software engineer with a passion for accessibility and progressive enhancement. I specialise in shipping full-stack web applications, and love to dabble in design, local ML, AI-assisted development, Linux, and entrepreneurship.

EXPERIENCE

- **National Health Service** London, UK
Tech Lead (Contract) Jan 2023 – Apr 2026
 - **Manage vaccinations in schools:** Mavis is a national service that records consent and vaccinations. I was the tech lead from initial setup of the Ruby on Rails monolith, to public launch, to scaling up to millions of patients.
 - **Mavis reporting:** Drove the implementation of a Python Flask microservice to expose tabular data and CSV exports for Mavis users, with heavy emphasis on materialised views, caching, queues, and PostgreSQL performance optimisation.
 - **Gromit:** Built a RAG-based agent that reads code and chat history to answer questions inside Slack. The bot handles hundreds of messages per day, helps with onboarding, and is being spun out into a standalone SaaS product.
- **Department for Education** London, UK
Tech Lead (Contract) Jan 2022 – Dec 2022
 - **Find a Lost TRN:** Helps teachers recover their Teacher Reference Number. Built and scaled the project and the team to go live, then led the architecture spike and built the OIDC SSO client component as part of the Get an Identity service.
 - **Teaching Regulation Authority:** Bootstrapped two national services: Apply for Qualified Teacher Status, and Refer Serious Misconduct. Interviewed developers, scaffolded out the apps, deploy pipeline and CI, path to live, wrote ADRs.
- **Ministry of Justice** London, UK
Senior Developer (Contract) Sep 2021 – Dec 2021
 - **Manage Supervisions (HMPPS):** Carried out an accessibility audit and handled the fixes over 2 weeks. The team was very satisfied and retained me for 3 months to help them deliver on their roadmap.
- **Meta** London, UK
Software Engineer Jan 2021 – Jul 2021
 - **Workplace:** Accessibility squad. Fixed accessibility issues toward WCAG 2.2, wrote the team's accessibility statement.
 - **Empathy Lab:** Wrote a design doc and prototypes for an accessibility testing tool, designed as a browser extension that simulates disabilities and common assistive technology interactions.
- **Department for Education** London, UK
Tech Lead / Senior Developer (Contract) Sep 2018 – Nov 2020
 - **Find and Apply for Teacher Training:** A national service for teachers in England. Led the candidate-facing side to public beta in Nov 2019; iterated through 2020 to 100k+ applications per cycle. Mentored 5 developers.

PAST EXPERIENCE

Gamesys (2018), **Graphit Systems** (2017–18), **Government Digital Service** (SC Security Clearance, 2016–17), **Timecounts** (2015–16), **Workangel** (2014–15), **ReadForward** (2013–14)

EDUCATION

- **London South Bank University** London, UK
Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Systems and Networks, Transferred from UniBuc 2014 – 2016

PROJECTS

- **keepthingsopen.com (2026):** I co-wrote an open letter to NHS leadership, asking them to keep their code open. It received over 2200 signatures from notable industry leaders: Matt Hancock, Cory Doctorow, Dan Abramov, Rich Harris, and many others.
- **tuicraft.vararu.org (2026):** A WoW chat client for the terminal, designed to be used by OpenClaw and other AI agents to play the popular MMO. Built with Bun, full test coverage, while leveraging heavily AI code generation. Open source, AGPLv3.
- **zp-voicemod (2026):** I reverse engineered the ZERO PARADES game and wrote a pipeline that trains a voice model (hubert-bsqvae-small) on a target voice and patches every sound file in the game with your desired voice. Open source, GPLv3.
- **untitled.ink (2025):** An interactive fiction platform, featuring a Claude Code-style agentic editor, the Ink markup language, a hot-reloading preview, and video/image generation & editing on Replicate or ComfyUI. Not yet released.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Ruby, Python, Rust, C#
- **Tools:** Bun, React.js, Next.js, Node.js, Astro.js, Flask, Ruby on Rails, Hotwire, Tailwind, PostgreSQL, SQLite
- **Infrastructure:** AWS, Azure, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Kamal, DigitalOcean, Vultr, CI, CD
- **Specialties:** Accessibility (WCAG, ARIA), testing (Playwright, RSpec, Jest, TDD), security, performance, design systems
- **AI / ML:** RAG, ComfyUI, agentic workflows, LlamaIndex, local LLMs (Ollama), embeddings, Replicate, Claude Agent SDK, Claude Code, Codex, OpenCode, MCP, pgvector, voice conversion (VC), OpenClaw